Sunday
Los Angeles Times

$3.66 DESIGNATED AREAS HIGHER © 2026 WST SUNDAY, OCTOBER 18, 2026 latimes.com



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

'NO KINGS' RALLIES IN CALIFORNIA AND BEYOND

Protesters march through downtown Los Angeles as part of the nationwide "No Kings" demonstrations Saturday calling for early voter turnout in the upcoming Nov. 3 midterm elections. **CALIFORNIA, B3**

Battle with feds escalates over state voter rolls

Trump administration lays groundwork to challenge unfavorable midterm results.

BY KEVIN RECTOR

First came the letter from acting Deputy Atty. Gen. Trent McCotter — just three weeks before the Nov. 3 election — demanding that Los Angeles County's top election official launch a sweeping investigation into thousands of voters the Trump administration alleges are "likely noncitizens" and withhold their ballots in the meantime.

The letter arrived with a thumb drive purporting to contain the list of voters in question, and a handwritten note providing the password. Dean Logan, head of the L.A. County Registrar-Recorder/County Clerk's office, said accessing the device would break security protocols, and he wouldn't open it.

Then came an Excel spreadsheet, listing some 20,000 voters by name, date of birth and address. It appeared to include voters from across California, not just L.A. County, and provided no information on the Trump administration's methodology for questioning those voters. Logan's office again pushed back.

"We cannot withhold or refuse to count ballots based solely on unverified allegations, nor can we disregard the legal requirements governing our election — and we certainly have no authority to act on records that are outside of our jurisdiction," Logan said.

On Friday, the back and forth escalated yet again, when the Justice Department warned in a letter to L.A. County attorneys that county election officials who tabulate ballots from the flagged voters could face criminal prosecution for being "aiders and abettors to a federal crime."

For the last week, Trump administration officials and California election leaders

[See **Election,** A8]

In Texas Senate race, test of party loyalty

Voters weigh Talarico vs. Paxton as Trump's immigration raids put GOP control at risk.

BY ANA CEBALLOS

McALLEN, Texas — On a quiet corner of downtown McAllen, past shops selling quinceañera gowns and perfumes, about 30 people trickled into a small brewery on Wednesday evening to watch James Talarico, the Democratic Senate nominee in Texas, take questions from voters in a CNN town hall.

With beers and tacos, they gathered in front of a large projector screen. Karyme Segura, 18, sat at the front, listening closely as Talarico said federal immigration agents should be going after violent criminals, not "terrorizing our communities" and breaking up families.

Segura clapped. The message was personal to her. A day earlier, her stepfather had been deported to Mexico. Since his detention, her mother has been afraid to leave the house, she said. Now Segura has turned to politics, hoping to change the conditions that have left her family fractured and rattled.

"I just have to do something," Segura said. "I am hoping that after the election my mom will feel more secure. That if Texas turns blue, Trump will feel threatened."

Segura is the kind of voter Democrats are counting on as Talarico, a state representative from Austin, tries to defeat Ken Paxton, the state's Republican attorney general, to become the first Democrat to win a statewide race in Texas since 1994. The race could decide control of the Senate, and has become one of the most high-profile and bitterly fought contests this year.

Talarico, a former teacher and Presbyterian seminarian, has courted vot-

[See **Texas,** A8]

Fraud, waste accusations roil EV voucher program

Green transportation initiative for trucks and buses faces allegations of mismanagement, poor oversight

BY TONY BRISCOE AND SANDHYA KAMBHAMPATI

With over $1 billion spent, California's Clean Truck and Bus Voucher Incentive Project is one of the state's most well-financed environmental initiatives.

By subsidizing up to 90% of the cost of hybrid and zero-emission vehicles, state officials say the project has helped businesses and transit agencies deploy nearly 12,000 trucks, buses and vans throughout California — particularly in neighborhoods that have been plagued by cancer-causing diesel pollution.

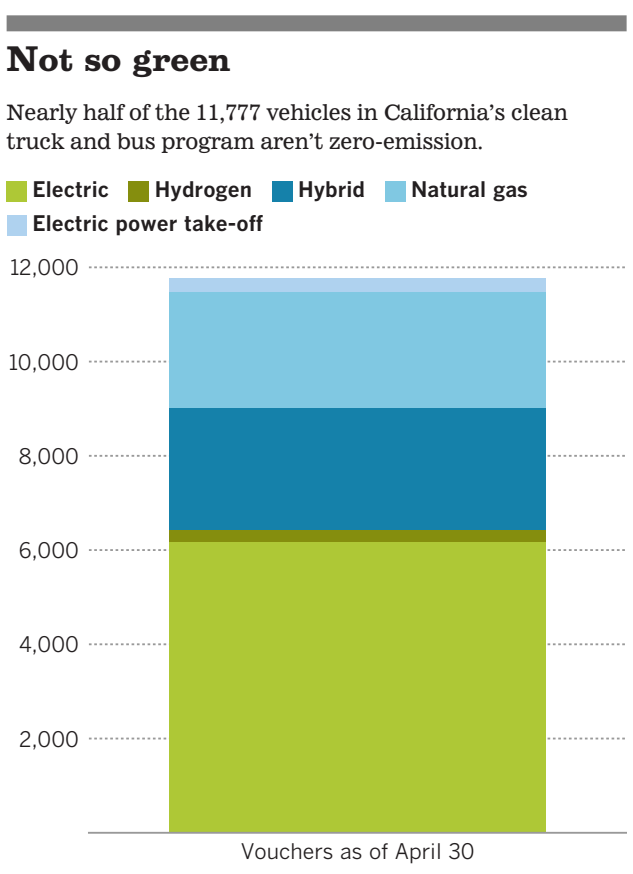
But what was designed 17 years ago to be the nation's premier green transportation initiative is now facing accusations of fraud, waste and poor oversight.

Although officials have described the program as a "resounding success," state authorities have launched an investigation into an EV manufacturer that allegedly received nearly $1 million in public funds for "vehicles that did not exist," according to a ruling in a civil case involving the manufacturer. Authorities are also probing whether vehicle identifica-

[See **Vouchers,** A12]

Not so green

Nearly half of the 11,777 vehicles in California's clean truck and bus program aren't zero-emission.



Times analysis

SANDHYA KAMBHAMPATI Los Angeles Times

IMPACT IN STATE: California paid Nikola Corp. $50 million for its vehicles. **A14**

Raman not a fan of L.A. Olympics

Mayoral candidate said her aim now is to ensure the city is protected financially.

BY JAMES RAINEY

The next mayor of Los Angeles will preside over what many are calling the largest athletic event in U.S. history — and that mayor could be someone who didn't even want the 2028 Summer Olympic Games here in the first place.

When she ran for City Council in 2020, Nithya Raman gave a clear "no" when asked if she supported the Olympics coming to Los Angeles. But if she beats incumbent Mayor Karen Bass in the Nov. 3 election, Raman will take center stage during the international sports extravaganza.

Raman's stated opposition to the Olympics came in response to a questionnaire to council candidates from the Democratic Socialists of America.

Asked if she supported having the 2028 Summer Games here, Raman wrote: "No — especially not after the way it was approved. There was no vetting of this process, extremely rushed budgeting outreach, and the residents of our city had no say in any of it."

After she was elected, Raman was one of two council members to vote against the primary contract outlining the partnership between the city and the Olympic organizing committee, LA28. She also opposed the expansion and remodeling of the Los

[See **Raman,** A9]

Students hit by data breach

Hackers steal millions of test-takers' information

BY HOWARD BLUME, ANDREW KHOURI AND JAWEED KALEEM

Hackers have stolen the data — including names, addresses and disability records — of millions of current and former California public school students who took the state's mandated standardized tests that annually assess their academic proficiency, education officials announced Friday.

The compromised information affects many more than the state's current 5.7 million public school students as the breach dates back to 2023 enrollments. Students who left California but did not confirm their transfer to another school also were affected, dating back to 2006.

The data breach involved Educational Testing Service, or ETS, which provides extensive services to California. While the first public notice was Friday, school district leaders received word on Oct. 2.

State education officials "are urgently working with a team of state agencies to investigate and determine scope and impact of the incident, including what information may have been affected," according to a letter from state Deputy Supt. Mary Nicely.

ETS, a nonprofit assessment organization, helps manage and provide testing-related services for students enrolled in California public

[See **Hack,** A9]



ADRIANA HELDIZ CalMatters

PROHIBITION Brewing Co. in Vista, Calif., is closing its doors this month. Above, Kyle Adams pours a beer.

Last call at some craft breweries in California

BY DEBORAH BRENNAN

To the dozen regular customers sipping the final ales and lagers at Prohibition Brewing Co. in Vista, Calif., on a recent Friday night, it not only marks the end of an era but also raises questions about the future of craft beer.

"There's a sense of loss. It's like when 'Cheers' closed in the last episode," said Vista resident Greg Johnson, in a nod to the 1980s sitcom about a neighborhood bar, "where everybody knows your name."

Prohibition will shut its doors this month after the last kegs are drained, making it one of several high-profile brewery closures in San Diego, a region that pioneered the craft brew industry.

Japanese beer maker Sapporo is selling Stone Brewing, which it acquired in 2022. To the dismay of north San Diego County beer lovers, it's closing the brand's flagship site in Escondido, Stone Brewing World Bistro & Gardens,

[See **Beer,** A10]

Mexican coast braces for storm
El Niño has brought a record-shattering hurricane season to the Pacific and the nation's weary people. **WORLD, A3**

Outrage as Russia sanctions waived
Members of Congress had passed legislation in a bipartisan display of U.S. support for Ukraine in the war. **NATION, A7**

Today's coastline is not tomorrow's
With a fall forecast full of climate peril, beaches and homes could be lost, Steve Lopez writes. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Sunny and very warm. L.A. Basin: 89/66. **B8**

7 85944 10300 9